

WS2 - UG/PGT/ALEC Ethics Application Form

Investigator information

Application Submitter Details

Title

Mr

First Name

Changle

Surname

Zhao

Faculty

Faculty of Arts, Law and Social Sciences

Department

University of Bristol Business School

School

University of Bristol Business School

Telephone

Email

ae25749@bristol.ac.uk

Preferred Name or Also Known As

Faculty

Social Sciences and Law

School / Department / Centre

University of Bristol Business School

Are you a student submitting this ethics application as part of your degree qualification?

Yes

Please declare your level of study

Taught Masters

Supervisor Contact Details

Title

Dr

First Name

Linh

Surname

Duong

Department

Management

Faculty

Faculty of Arts, Law and Social Sciences

Email

en22211@bristol.ac.uk

Title

Dr

First Name

Linh

Surname

Duong

Department

Management

Faculty

Faculty of Arts, Law and Social Sciences

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en22211@bristol.ac.uk

Are you an academic member of staff submitting an ethics application on behalf of a student(s) as part of their degree qualification?

No

Second Supervisor Details. If University of Bristol, please provide their full name and title.

If external to the University of Bristol, please provide their name, organisation details, email address and telephone number.

N/A

Please provide details of any other researchers/collaborators involved in the study.

N/A

Are you submitting this ethics application on behalf of another researcher?

No

Ethics Committee Review

Has or will your research be submitted to another research ethics committee for research involving human participants, their tissue and or data?

- ☐ Yes
☒ No

Important Information - Please note:

It is extremely important that you select the **correct Research Ethics Committee (REC)** to review your research ethics application.

The REC selected, will determine the questions you are asked to complete on this online form and the research ethics committee that will review your research ethics application.

Please note, if you select the incorrect ethics committee, this may delay the review of your ethics application as your ethics application will need to be returned to you so that you can select the correct REC and complete the relevant questions on the online form.

If you are unsure of the correct research ethics committee to select please contact research-ethics@bristol.ac.uk

Please select the Research Ethics Committee (REC) to review your research ethics application:

Business School Research Ethics Committee



To proceed to the next page select 'Next' in the Actions tiles.

To save your application for completion and submission at a later date please select 'Save' in the Actions tiles.

Lead questions

Does your research involve any of the following? Tick all that apply

- ☐ Patients, clients or carers of an NHS Trust or Social Care organisation
☐ Solely staff or premises of an NHS Trust or Social Care organisation?
☐ Staff, residents or premises of one or more care homes
☐ Participants who are lacking or have diminished mental capacity
☐ Staff, inmates or premises of one or more prisons
☐ Staff, participants or premises of one or more local authority departments
☒ None of the above

To proceed to the next page select 'Next' in the Actions tiles.

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Brief study outline

Study Title

How AI-Supported Digital Customer Touchpoints Influence Service Trust in Online Domestic Cleaning Platforms

Brief Project Outline (up to approximately 300 words in plain English)

This study examines how AI-supported and digital customer touchpoints influence service trust in online domestic cleaning platforms. The research focuses on digital interactions such as online booking, platform communication, customer support, ratings and reviews, service recovery, recommendation tools, and complaint handling.

The study will use secondary data from publicly available online customer reviews of domestic cleaning and home service platforms. No interviews, surveys, experiments, or direct contact with participants will be conducted. The analysis will focus only on review text, star ratings where available, review dates where available, platform name, country or region, and trust-related themes.

The research will compare selected platforms across China, the United States, and selected European developed markets such as the United Kingdom, France, and Germany. The data will be analysed using descriptive statistics, sentiment analysis, keyword analysis, and thematic coding. Key themes may include convenience, responsiveness, reliability, transparency, privacy concerns, service recovery, platform accountability, and perceived service quality.

All data will be anonymised. Usernames, profile images, exact links, contact details, and any identifiable personal information will not be collected or reported. The project is low risk because it uses publicly available secondary data and does not involve vulnerable participants or sensitive personal data.

Estimated dates of research data collection

Please note that you must not start data collection for your research project until you have received a formal favourable ethics opinion from the appropriate Research Ethics Committee (REC). Please factor in the research ethics review timescales when selecting the estimated dates for research data collection.

Anticipated Start Date

01/07/2026

Anticipated End Date

31/08/2026

To proceed to the next page select 'Next' in the Actions tiles.

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Data collection method

BUSINESS SCHOOL RESEARCH ETHICS

APPLICATION FORM: TAUGHT POSTGRADUATE STUDENTS

This form must be completed for each piece of research carried out by all taught post-graduate students in the Business School.

Students should discuss their proposed research with their supervisors who will then approve and sign this form before forwarding to the relevant dissertation convenor (or in some cases unit convenor or programme director) who will approve the form on behalf of the Business School REC when they are happy with the contents.

Failure to get approval prior to conducting any fieldwork may result in the University taking action for research misconduct – the outcome of such action may be that you are unable to submit your fieldwork findings for assessment and **your degree may not be awarded.**

Once your study is approved, you must follow the plan described in this form. You should remember that ethics is an on-going process, ie your ethical thinking is not 'done' when your form is signed. It is about how you act as a researcher. You should remain reflexive throughout the research process and think about how the research is impacting on your participants and yourself. You should refer to this completed form throughout your research process to make sure you are remaining within your ethical approval. If you wish to change your research plan, then you must discuss this with your supervisor. If the change is very small your supervisor can approve the change. However, if the change is more significant, you will need to ask for an amendment to your ethical approval. Your supervisor and dissertation convenor must approve this change in writing. If you do not get approval for changes, then you won't have ethical approval for the change, and it may result in the University taking action for research misconduct.

Terminology used in this form:

1. **Primary research** includes any research that collects new data such as interviews, focus groups, observations, online surveys, new data collected via a social media post etc.
2. **Secondary analysis/literature review** relates to the re-analysis of data that already exists such as analysis of publicly available documents or tv programmes, analysis of existing social media posts, reviews systematic or otherwise, or statistical analysis of analysis of publicly available datasets etc.

Please select the method of data collection relevant to your research. Tick all that apply

- ☐ Primary research data collection
- ☒ Secondary data analysis

Please provide your student number

2719338

To proceed to the next page select 'Next' in the Actions tiles.

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Study design and background

Research involving humans by all academic and related Staff and Students in the University of Bristol Business School is subject to the standards set out in the University of Bristol Ethics of Research Policy and Procedure which can be found at: <http://www.bristol.ac.uk/red/research-governance/practice-training/researchethicspolicy.pdf>

It is a requirement prior to the commencement of all funded and non-funded research that this form be completed and submitted to the School's Research Ethics Committee (REC). The REC will be responsible for issuing certification that the research meets acceptable ethical standards and will, if necessary, require changes to the research methodology or reporting strategy. It is a requirement that prior to the commencement of all funded and non-funded research that this form be completed and submitted to the School's Research Ethics Committee (REC). The REC will be responsible for issuing certification that the research meets acceptable ethical standards and will, if necessary, require changes to the research methodology or reporting strategy.

For those intending to carry out secondary analysis of data or a systematic review:

Please provide details of where you are getting your data set from and how you will use this data. Data sets must be stored on the University of Bristol server.

What sources / secondary datasets will you use?

The study will use publicly available online customer reviews from domestic cleaning and home service platforms. Sources may include review pages and platform listings such as Trustpilot, Yelp, app store reviews, Google Play or Apple App Store reviews, BBB complaints where publicly available, and public review pages for platforms such as Taskrabbit, Homeaglow, Housekeep, Fantastic Services, Helping, Meituan/Dianping, Tian'e Daojia and Daojia App. The study will also use academic literature from databases such as Google Scholar, Scopus, Web of Science and the University of Bristol Library.

Where will you get these data from (e.g. ESRC Data Archive, systematic literature review, document archive). Please describe your selection criteria and how you will locate/access the data?

The review data will be located through public search, platform review pages, app store review pages, and public consumer review websites. Selection criteria will include relevance to domestic cleaning or home service platforms, availability in public online sources, clear review text, and relevance to trust-related customer experiences. The study will focus on selected regional contexts, including China, the United States, and selected European developed markets such as the United Kingdom, France and Germany. Only publicly accessible reviews will be used. Reviews requiring private login access, closed groups, private messages, or restricted databases will not be collected.

If necessary, how will you obtain permission to use these data? This would apply to data sets where it is usual for the researcher to sign an end user licence.

The study will only use publicly available secondary data. No private accounts, closed groups, restricted datasets, or licensed confidential datasets will be used. Where a platform's terms of use restrict automated scraping or reuse, data will be collected manually and only in limited form for academic analysis, or the source will be excluded. No usernames, profile images, contact details, exact profile links, or other identifiable personal information will be collected or reported. If permission is required for any specific dataset, the dataset will not be used unless permission is obtained.

How will you analyse the data?

The data will be analysed using secondary data analysis and content analysis. Review texts will be cleaned and anonymised, then coded for trust-related themes such as reliability, responsiveness, professionalism, safety, privacy concerns, booking convenience, communication quality, platform transparency, service recovery, refunds, cancellations and platform accountability. Descriptive statistics will be used to summarise review ratings, platforms and regional patterns. Keyword frequency analysis and basic sentiment analysis may be used to support the thematic analysis. Findings will be compared across China, the United States and selected European markets. The analysis will report aggregated patterns and anonymised examples only.

What ethical issues will you consider when undertaking secondary data analysis? i.e. will you consider the quality of the papers/programmes etc reviewed?

The main ethical issues are privacy, anonymisation, responsible use of publicly available online reviews, data quality, and fair representation of customer experiences. I will not collect usernames, profile images, contact details, exact profile links, or any other identifiable personal information. Review examples used in the dissertation will be anonymised and paraphrased where appropriate to reduce identifiability. I will only use publicly accessible sources and will avoid private groups, restricted pages, or content requiring special access. I will also consider the quality and relevance of the data by selecting reviews that are clearly related to domestic cleaning or home service platforms and trust-related customer experiences.

Clearly state any potential risk to you as the researcher and how you will address this risk.

The risk to me as the researcher is low. The study does not involve direct contact with participants, interviews, surveys, fieldwork, or work with vulnerable groups. Potential risks include exposure to negative or distressing customer complaints and possible breach of platform terms if data are collected inappropriately. I will address these risks by using only publicly available data, avoiding restricted or private sources, collecting data in a limited and responsible way, and discussing any uncertainty with my supervisor before collecting data. I will store the data securely on my password-protected computer and/or University of Bristol storage.

Supporting Information

Please provide any additional information relevant to your secondary data research.

This project uses secondary online review data only. No primary data collection will be conducted. The study will not collect sensitive personal data, private messages, closed-group content, or identifiable information. The analysis will focus on aggregated patterns across platforms and regions rather than individual reviewers. Any examples included in the dissertation will be anonymised and used only to illustrate broader themes. Data collection will begin only after ethics approval has been granted.

Please upload any supporting information relevant to your secondary data research.

Supporting Information

To be completed by your named supervisor

This free text box below is to be completed by your supervisor.

Your form must now be reviewed by your supervisor confirming that any ethics related issues relating to your proposed research have been addressed and your ethics application is complete.

So that your supervisor can confirm this, please follow these steps:

1. If you have not already done so, share your ethics application with your supervisor by selecting the 'Share' button on the left hand side of the form.
2. Input your supervisor email address in the pop-up box, and grant them 'Read' and 'Write' and 'submit' access.
3. You will then need to email your supervisor separately with the following email requesting them to complete this section:

"Dear [Supervisor Name]

My research ethics application is now ready for you to review and confirm that the ethics related issues relating to my proposed research have been addressed and my ethics application is complete. Can you please click on the link below, complete the free text in the ethics application form to confirm this.

[Insert application URL]

All the best"

Once this section has been completed by your supervisor you please select on the next page, and begin the Ethics Academic Checker declaration process on the next page.

The research uses secondary data. I have no concern about the research.

Supervisor Guidance Note:

Please state your name and the date of signature.

Linh Duong 29/06/2026

Business School Ethics Academic Checker Declaration

Guidance Note

In order to ensure that your ethics application is submitted successfully please follow the steps below.

Your form must now be reviewed by your assigned Academic Ethics Checker. They will determine whether your ethics application requires further review. So that your Academic Ethics Checker can complete their declaration the following steps must be completed.

1. Share your ethics application with the Academic Ethics Checker by selecting the 'Share' button on the left hand side of the form.
2. Input your Academic Ethics Checker's email address in the pop-up box, and grant them 'Read' and 'Write' access.
3. You will then need to email your Academic Ethics Checker separately with the following email requesting them to complete this section:

"Dear [Ethics Academic Checker Name]

My research ethics application is now ready for you to review and sign prior to submission. Can you please click on the link below, complete the Academic Ethics Checker declaration page and select the signature button.

[Insert application URL]

All the best"

Once the form has been signed by your named Academic Ethics Checker you will then need to complete the signature declaration on the next page.

Business School Ethics Checker Determination - Please tick the appropriate box below:

- ☒ I have reviewed the student's proposed research project, and believe that no further ethical review is necessary.
- ☐ I have reviewed the student's proposed research project, and recommend that the application is reviewed by the Business School Research Ethics Committee

Academic Ethics Checker Signature

Signed: This form was signed by Dr Linh Duong (en22211@bristol.ac.uk) on 29/06/2026 13:41

Signatures

Applicant Signature

I confirm that my responses are complete and accurate.

I understand that any errors or omissions may cause a delay in the processing of my application.

Signed: This form was signed by Mr Changle Zhao (ae25749@bristol.ac.uk) on 29/06/2026 15:17

Supervisor signature request

As the named supervisor please confirm:

1. I have read and reviewed this ethics application.
2. I am satisfied with the content and completeness of this ethics application.

Signed: This form was signed by Dr Linh Duong (en22211@bristol.ac.uk) on 29/06/2026 17:45

Submission Reminder

Please note - Once all signatures have been obtained. You must ensure you select the **Submit** button on the left hand side of the form.

If you are unsure whether your application has been submitted, please contact business-school-ethics@bristol.ac.uk.